Deron - recipe #1

INGREDIENTS

THE BUTTER LAB'S PIE DOUGH (1/2 RECIPE FOR A SINGLE-CRUST PIE, PAR-BAKED AND COOLED)

TOMATO FILLING
3 ½ lb. vine-ripe tomatoes (about 12), cored, seeded, and cut into ½-inch dice, divided
2 teaspoons salt, divided
1 teaspoon sugar, divided
1 tablespoon butter
1 large yellow onion, thinly sliced with the grain
1 teaspoon picked thyme
2 tablespoon extra-virgin olive oil
1/4 teaspoon (10 turns) freshly ground black pepper
1/3 cup packed whole basil leaves

TOPPING AND ASSEMBLY
1/2 cup mayonnaise
1/3 cup grated fontina
1/3 cup grated Parmigiano-Reggiano
2 large Roma or heirloom tomatoes, thinly sliced and blotted dry with paper towels

METHOD

MAKE THE FILLING:

Toss half of the diced tomatoes with 1/2 teaspoon salt and 1/2 teaspoon sugar. Set them over a colander to drain while you get everything else ready, *at least an hour.*

Preheat oven to 375°F.

In a medium sauté pan or skillet, melt the butter and then add the onion and ½ teaspoon salt. Cook over medium-low heat until deeply caramelized. This will take about 45 minutes. If the onion gets away from you and burns a little, add ¼ cup of water to the pan, scrape up the overbrowned bits, and keep going. In the end, you'll have a scant 2/3 cup of caramelized onion.

While the onions are caramelizing, toss the remaining diced tomatoes with 1/2 teaspoon salt, thyme, and olive oil. Spread in a single layer on a sheet tray with as much room separating the individual pieces as possible. Slide the tray onto the middle rack of your oven and roast for 30-35 minutes. You're looking for the tomatoes to dry out and brown slightly.

Once all the individual components are done, stir together the onion, the fresh and roasted diced tomatoes, the remaining salt, sugar, black pepper, and basil.

MAKE THE TOPPING AND ASSEMBLE THE PIE:

In a separate, smaller bowl, stir together the mayonnaise, fontina, and Parmigiano. Spoon the filling into your par-baked crust. Top with the cheese mixture and tomato slices. Bake in the middle of your oven for 30 minutes. You can serve this warm or at room temperature. Both have their virtues.

Recipe #2

Simply RECIPES

Best Tomato Pie

Tomato pie gives fresh summer tomatoes a little more heft, with basil, onion, and a creamy cheese topping in a buttery crust that browns on top and slices well.

By **Elise Bauer** Updated on September 22, 2026

Prep Time: 15 mins

Cook Time: 1 hr

Total Time: 1 hr 15 mins

Servings: 6 servings

Yield: 1 pie

Note:
If you want to take this recipe up a notch, you can caramelize the onions while prepping the other ingredients. If you do that, double the amount of onion.

This recipe calls for slicing fresh basil using a technique called chiffonade. To do this, stack the basil leaves on top of each other, roll them up like a cigar, starting at one end, slice the "cigar" crosswise into thin slices.

Ingredients

1 (9-inch) pie shell (homemade or store-bought)

3 to 4 large tomatoes

1/2 teaspoon kosher salt

1/2 cup chopped yellow or red onion (about 1/3 onion)

1/4 cup thinly sliced basil

2 cups (8 ounces/225 g) grated cheese (combination of sharp cheddar and Monterey Jack, or Gruyere or Mozzarella)

1/2 cup mayonnaise

1 teaspoon Frank's Hot Sauce or Tabasco, or to taste

Freshly ground black pepper

Directions

Step 1

Preheat the oven to 350°F (175°C).

Place the oven rack in the center of the oven.

Step 2

Pre-bake the crust:

If you are using a store-bought pie shell, follow the directions on the package for pre-baking, or pre-bake it in the oven for about 8 to 10 minutes (a little longer for a frozen pie shell), until lightly browned.

If you are using a homemade crust, press it into the pie plate and freeze for 30 minutes. Remove the plate from the freezer and press a sheet of aluminum foil into the crust to keep the sides of the pie crust from falling down as it cooks. Fill the pie with pie weights such as dry beans or rice to help hold the foil in place.

Pre-bake the homemade crust for 15 minutes, then remove the foil, use the tines of a fork to poke a few small holes in the bottom of the crust (for venting), and bake for 10 more minutes.

Step 3

Chop, salt, and drain the tomatoes:

Halve the tomatoes horizontally and squeeze as much juice from them as you can. Then roughly chop the tomatoes; you should have about 3 cups. Sprinkle the salt on the tomatoes and set them in a colander over a bowl to drain while you are pre-baking the crust.

Step 4

Layer pre-baked pie shell with onions, tomatoes, basil:

Spread the chopped onion over the bottom of your pre-baked pie crust shell.

Squeeze as much moisture as you can out of the chopped tomatoes, using either paper towels, a clean dish towel, or a potato ricer.

Spread the drained chopped tomatoes over the onions. Sprinkle the sliced basil over the tomatoes.

Step 5

Make cheese mixture, spread over tomatoes:

In a medium bowl, mix together the grated cheese, mayonnaise, Tabasco, and a sprinkling of freshly ground black pepper.

Spread the cheese mixture over the tomatoes.

Step 6

Bake:

Place in the oven and bake at 350°F (175°C) until browned and bubbly, 25 to 45 minutes.

Step 7

Enjoy!

Nutrition Facts

The Amalgam!

Devon's Notes:

Essentially, the combo recipe is as follows:

- 1 (9-inch) pie shell (I used the refrigerated Pillsbury pie crust, prebaked it for about 8 minutes before filling, and one the pie was assembled, I put it in the fridge overnight, baking it the next morning)
- 4 or 5 large tomatoes
- 3 tablespoons butter
- 1 large yellow onion, thinly sliced with the grain
- 1 teaspoon picked thyme
- 1/4 cup thinly sliced basil
- 2 cups (I used a combo of sharp cheddar, Monterey Jack, Mozzarella, Fontina, and Parmesan, all shredded or grated)
- 1/2 cup mayonnaise
- 1 teaspoon Frank's Hot Sauce or Tabasco, or to taste
- Freshly ground black pepper

1. Toss half of the diced tomatoes with 1/2 teaspoon salt. Set them over a colander to drain while you get everything else ready, *at least an hour.*
2. Preheat oven to 375°F.
3. In a medium sauté pan or skillet, melt the butter and then add the onion and 1/2 teaspoon salt. Cook over medium-low heat until deeply caramelized. This will take about 45 minutes. If the onion gets away from you and burns a little, add 1/4 cup of water to the pan, scrape up the overbrowned bits, and keep going. In the end, you'll have a scant 2/3 cup of caramelized onion.
4. While the onions are caramelizing, toss the remaining diced tomatoes with 1/2 teaspoon salt, thyme, and olive oil. Spread in a single layer on a sheet tray with as much room separating the individual pieces as possible. Slide the tray onto the

middle rack of your oven and roast for 30-35 minutes. You're looking for the tomatoes to dry out and brown slightly.

5. Once all the individual components are done, stir together the onion, the fresh and roasted diced tomatoes, the remaining salt , black pepper, and basil, and add to pie crust
6. In a medium bowl, mix together the grated cheese, mayonnaise, Tabasco, and a sprinkling of freshly ground black pepper.
7. Spread the cheese mixture over the tomatoes.
8. Place in the oven and bake at 350°F (175°C) until browned and bubbly, 25 to 45 minutes.